



Step-by-Step: Basic spreadsheet tasks

This reading outlines the steps the instructor performs in the next video, [Basic spreadsheet tasks](#). In the video, the instructor explains how to organize a spreadsheet and demonstrates how organizing data helps you understand it more fully.

Keep this step-by-step guide open as you watch the video. It can serve as a helpful reference if you need additional context or clarification while following the video steps. This is not a graded activity, but you can complete these steps to practice the skills demonstrated in the video.

What you'll need

If you'd like to follow along with the first two examples in this video, choose a spreadsheet tool and open a blank sheet.

If you would like to access the other spreadsheet the instructor uses in this video, click the link to the dataset to create a copy. If you don't have a Google account, you may download the data directly from the attachments below.

Link to population data: [Population of Latin and Caribbean Countries](#)

OR

[Population-Latin-and-Caribbean-Countries-2010-2019
XLSX File](#)

Example 1: Open a new spreadsheet

1. Open a new blank spreadsheet.
2. In the title bar, name it: Population, Latin and Caribbean Countries, 2010-2019.

Example 2: Create a new folder

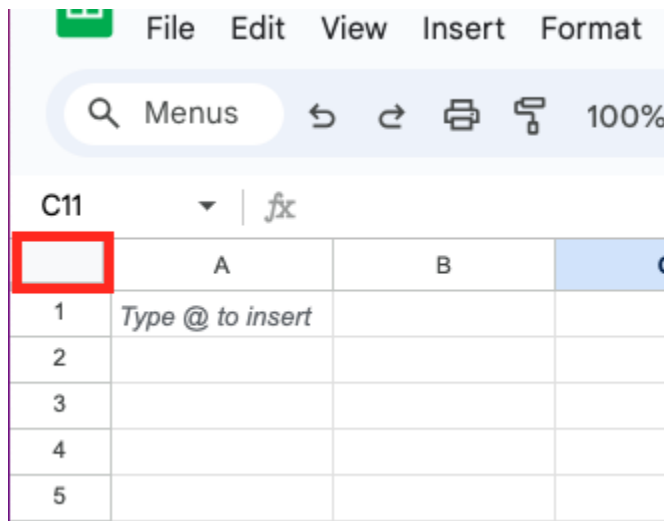
Organizing files in folders helps you locate the correct file more easily.

1. Select File, then select Move.
2. Select the New Folder icon.
3. Name the new folder Population Data.
4. Select the checkmark icon to move the spreadsheet to its new folder.

Example 3: Change cell size

Change the format of your spreadsheet to make it easier to understand.

1. Open the Population of Latin and Caribbean Countries spreadsheet and select [Use Template](#).
2. Select the cell where the column and row headers intersect.



3. Widen all columns by clicking and dragging the boundary between Columns D and E.

Example 4: Make attributes stand out

Adding formatting to cells that contain attribute labels help the attributes stand out.

1. Select cell 1 to select the entire first row.
2. Select the paint can icon called Fill color and choose a color. This will fill the cells in the row with your selected color, making the attributes stand out.
3. Select the B icon from the menu bar to bold the labels.

Example 5: Add a column

If you need to add a new attribute to your spreadsheet, add a new column.

1. Select cell I1.
2. From the Insert menu, select Column right from the menu bar. This inserts a column to the right of Column I.

Example 6: Delete a column

Organize your data by deleting an attribute.

1. Right click cell J1.
2. Select Delete column. This deletes the column and causes all the other columns to shift to the left.

Example 7: Add a border

Adding borders helps distinguish cells from one another.

1. Select the cell in the top-left corner of the image, above 1 and to the left of A.
2. Select the Borders icon from the menu.
3. Select All borders.